

NOICE & TOIT LLP

Corporate Travel and Expense Policy

Practical rules, daily limits, and reimbursement guidelines

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1 General Policy and Principles

1.1 Welcome to Noice & Toit LLP

At Noice & Toit LLP, our reputation rests on delivering rigorous professional counsel, high technical standards, and unquestioned integrity. As a global partnership with offices across London, Berlin, New York, Zurich, and Singapore, our professionals regularly travel to client sites, courtroom venues, research facilities, and international conferences.

This Expense Policy Handbook establishes a clear, practical framework for how we manage, substantiate, and reimburse professional business expenditures. It applies to every partner, associate, analyst, business operations specialist, intern, and retained contractor across all offices and subsidiaries.

We treat company money as our collective partnership capital. Our policy is grounded in trust, simplicity, and personal responsibility. We do not micro-manage legitimate work travel, but we expect all team members to exercise sound judgment, prudence, and fair dealing.

1.2 The Noice & Toit Operating Philosophy

Our core philosophy is simple: when spending company funds or incurring expenses that will be billed to clients, act as a prudent steward. Ask yourself whether an independent observer or client audit committee would consider the expenditure reasonable, necessary, and proportionate.

DO Spend partnership funds with care

Book sensible itineraries, preserve original itemized documentation, and submit claims promptly at the end of each trip. When in doubt about whether an unusual expenditure is allowable, discuss it with your practice group leader before committing funds.

DON'T Treat expense accounts as personal perquisites

Never use company credit cards, partner accounts, or expense reports for personal living costs, leisure items, or family obligations. Keep your personal and firm finances strictly separate at all times.

1.3 Roles and Administrative Responsibilities

Effective expense management is a shared responsibility across three key groups within the firm:

1.3.1 The Traveler or Incurring Employee

- Understand and follow the guidelines outlined in this handbook before making travel commitments.
- Use our approved corporate booking channels and preferred hotel partners whenever available.
- Collect and digitize complete, itemized tax invoices and folios at the point of sale.
- File well-organized expense reports within thirty days of incurring the cost.
- Promptly resolve inquiries or deduction notices raised by the Finance team.

1.3.2 The Approving Manager or Practice Leader

- Confirm that every expense claimed serves an authentic business purpose connected to a project, client matter, or approved firm initiative.
- Verify that hotel room rates, meal totals, and transportation choices fall within policy caps.
- Ensure that billable expenses match client engagement letters and billing guidelines.
- Reject or adjust unsupported line items before approving reports in the portal.

1.3.3 Global Finance and People Operations

- Maintain and publish updated mileage rates, hotel city tiers, and foreign currency conversion schedules.
- Audit submissions for regulatory compliance, tax deductibility, and internal policy conformance.
- Disburse approved reimbursements into employee payroll accounts on scheduled bi-weekly cycles.

- Manage corporate card issuance, credit limits, and banking vendor relationships.

1.4 Ethical Standards and Anti-Corruption Compliance

Noice & Toit LLP adheres to strict international legal standards, including the Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA), the UK Bribery Act, and applicable European anti-corruption directives.

DO Comply with anti-bribery regulations

Ensure all client hospitality, gifts, and business entertainment are transparent, modest, and properly documented with full attendee details. Hospitality must never be offered to influence official actions or obtain improper commercial advantages.

DON'T Provide entertainment to public officials without legal clearance

Never purchase meals, travel, gifts, or entertainment for government officials, regulatory authorities, or state-owned enterprise representatives without advance written approval from General Counsel.

1.5 Regular Audits, Deductions, and Dispute Resolution

Finance reviews all expense reports submitted through the firm portal. The majority of submissions pass through automated validation and routine manager review, but Finance also conducts random and targeted audits.

DO Retain digital copies of receipts

Keep digital copies or photos of your submitted receipts for at least twelve months after report settlement. Tax authorities or client auditors frequently request historical supporting documentation during retrospective reviews.

DON'T Submit claims with missing or ambiguous details

Do not submit generic descriptions like “business dinner” or “travel expenses”. State the client code, project milestone, or administrative purpose clearly to avoid unnecessary audit delays.

1.5.1 Clawback Rights and Disciplinary Procedures

If an audit reveals that an unapproved, exaggerated, or prohibited expense was paid out in error, Finance will notify the employee and offset the amount against the next payroll disbursement. Intentional falsification of expense reports constitutes serious misconduct and will result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment or dissolution of partnership status.

1.6 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What if I am working on a matter where the client agreed to pay higher hotel rates?

A: If a client contract explicitly authorizes higher lodging or airfare thresholds than our internal policy, attach a copy of the client billing approval or engagement letter addendum to your expense report. Your practice director must countersign the submission.

Q: Can my administrative assistant submit expense reports on my behalf?

A: Yes. Executive assistants may prepare and submit draft expense claims on behalf of team members. However, the traveler remains personally responsible for the accuracy of all claimed amounts and must digitally approve the submission before manager routing.

Q: How do partner draw accounts relate to corporate expense reporting?

A: Equity and salaried partners must adhere to the same documentation, itemization, and approval requirements

as associates. Disallowed personal expenses cannot be hidden within general firm expenses and will be charged directly to the partner personal draw account.

2 Expense Submission and Documentation

2.1 Overview of the Submission Process

Timely and accurate submission of expenses keeps our financial records current, supports accurate billing to clients, and ensures you get reimbursed quickly. All expense submissions at Noice & Toit LLP must be filed through the central Noice & Toit Expense Portal (accessible via single sign-on from your desktop or mobile device).

Each receipt is submitted as its own expense line. A line consists of exactly two things: the receipt image and a short submission note written by the employee. Finance evaluates every line on those two inputs alone.

2.2 Deadlines and the Accounting Calendar

Our accounting team closes general ledger accounts at the end of each calendar month. Untracked expenses distort monthly departmental budgeting, delay billable client invoices, and create complications for quarterly tax returns.

DO Submit expense reports within 30 days

File your expense report within thirty calendar days of returning from a business trip or incurring a local out-of-pocket expense. Submitting reports promptly guarantees reimbursement in the next bi-weekly payroll cycle.

DON'T Hold claims longer than 60 days

Do not hold receipts past sixty days. Reports submitted between 61 and 90 days after the expense date require formal written approval from your practice vice president. Claims submitted after 90 days are strictly forfeited and will not be reimbursed under any circumstance.

2.2.1 Fiscal Year-End Cut-Off Notice

Special cut-off rules apply at the end of our fiscal year (December 31st). All expenses incurred through December 15th must be submitted no later than December 20th to ensure costs are accrued into the correct tax year. Expenses incurred between December 16th and December 31st must be filed no later than the first Friday of January.

2.3 Receipt Substantiation Standards

Both tax authorities (including the IRS, HMRC, and German Finanzamt) and our commercial clients require full substantiation before business deductions or reimbursements are recognized. A proof of payment must establish five core facts:

1. **Who:** The legal name and business address of the vendor. Hotel folios and commercial invoices must additionally show the vendor's VAT or tax registration number.
2. **When:** The date and, for restaurants and taxis, the time the transaction occurred.
3. **What:** An itemized list showing individual line items, service descriptions, unit costs, and quantities.
4. **How much:** The total gross amount paid, broken down by net price, applicable tax rates, and tips.
5. **Currency:** The exact currency in which the transaction was charged.

DO Upload itemized merchant folios and bills

Always request and upload the complete itemized bill. For restaurant visits, provide the detailed dining bill listing all dishes and beverages ordered. For hotels, upload the itemized checkout folio showing daily room charges, taxes, and incidentals.

DON'T Rely on credit card charge slips

Never submit terminal charge slips showing only a merchant name, a total amount, and a masked card number. A card slip proves that money changed hands, but it does not prove what was purchased. Finance rejects any expense line supported only by a summary card slip, regardless of amount or explanation in the note.

2.4 The Submission Note

The submission note is the only narrative Finance reads. No screenshots, e-mail threads, approval tickets, or card statements can be attached to an expense line; anything Finance needs to know must be stated in the note. Statements in the note are accepted at face value and audited retrospectively. A knowingly false statement is misconduct under Chapter 1.

DO State the facts that unlock reimbursement

Keep notes to one or two plain sentences and include the facts relevant to the receipt type:

- **Restaurants and bars:** The business purpose, the external organization(s) present, and the total number of attendees including yourself.
- **Hotels:** The trip purpose. For nights falling on a weekend or public holiday, name the conference or client meeting (see Figure 1). For laundry or parking charges, state the garment incident or the vehicle (see Chapter 6).
- **Taxis and ride-hailing:** Destination and purpose. For fares above the unjustified-ride threshold, state which justification in Chapter 5 applies.
- **Fuel:** Identify the rental vehicle the fuel was for.
- **Flights and rail:** The trip purpose. For bookings made inside seven days of departure, the reason. For premium cabins or first-class rail, the qualifying condition from Chapters 4 and 5.
- **Commercial invoices (equipment, supplies, event materials):** What the items are for, the event or project name, and, where Chapter 10 requires it, the approver's role or the IT ticket number.

DON'T Leave the note blank or generic

Notes such as "dinner", "business lunch", or "supplies" do not satisfy any documentation requirement. Where this handbook says a fact must be stated in the note and it is missing, Finance applies the less favorable branch of the rule. Routine transit (public transport, short taxi rides, standard rail tickets) may carry an empty note.

2.4.1 Notes We Have Actually Received

The Expense Auditing Team keeps an anonymized collection of memorable notes for training purposes. "Dinner." is the most common entry and the least useful. "Emergency ducks, see Hamburg" has become shorthand for a note that assumes context the reader does not have. The best notes in the collection are short, specific, and slightly boring: "Lunch with 2 engineers from Acme (3 attendees total) to review the Q3 rollout plan." Aim for boring.

2.5 Mobile Capture and Document Legibility

Most employees photograph receipts with smartphone cameras. The resulting image must be clear, legible, and suitable for formal tax inspection.

- Lay the receipt flat with adequate lighting and keep the entire receipt in frame, from the merchant header to the total footer.
- Thermal paper receipts from taxis, petrol stations, and cafes fade quickly; capture the photo within 24 hours of purchase.
- For multi-page hotel folios, upload every page in sequence.
- Finance may reject lines where amounts, line items, or the vendor cannot be read.

2.6 How Finance Calculates the Reimbursable Amount

Finance applies the rules in this handbook in a fixed order so that every reviewer arrives at the same figure. The steps are:

1. **Eligibility check.** If the receipt is a summary card slip, or the expense category is prohibited outright (Chapter 11), the line is **rejected** and nothing further is calculated.
2. **Remove non-reimbursable line items.** Deduct every prohibited item (alcohol where not permitted, minibar, spa, personal goods, prohibited fees) at its gross line price. Where the receipt adds tax on top of the subtotal, also deduct the tax charged on that item at the rate shown for the line. Where prices already include tax, the gross line price is the deduction.
3. **Apply item caps.** Where a specific line is capped (a nightly room rate, a laundry charge, a hotel parking night, a tip), reimburse up to the cap and deduct the excess.
4. **Apply category caps.** Apply the per-meal, per-person, or per-day caps in Chapter 7, Figure 2, and Chapter 10 to what remains.
5. **Determine the outcome.** If nothing was deducted, the line is **approved** in full. If something was deducted but a positive amount remains, the line is **partially approved** for the remaining amount. If nothing remains, the line is **rejected**.

DO Work through the steps yourself before submitting

Employees may enter the net business amount they expect to receive. Finance recalculates every line independently, so a self-reduced claim does not shortcut the audit, but it does speed up settlement.

2.7 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Do I need to keep the original paper receipts after uploading photos to the portal?

A: Once you have uploaded a legible image to the portal and your report has been approved by Finance, you may discard the paper slips, unless your local office jurisdiction requires physical paper retention. Check with your local office administrator.

Q: What happens if my expense report contains both billable and non-billable items?

A: Tag each line with the appropriate client billing code or internal administrative cost center. Your practice leader reviews the billable allocation during the approval step. Allocation does not change whether a line is reimbursable.

Q: My receipt is in a foreign language. Do I need to translate it?

A: No. Finance reads receipts in all major European and Asian languages. Do add a short English description of the purchase in the note when the item names are not self-explanatory.

3 Approval Workflows and Authority Limits

3.1 The Delegation of Authority (DoA) Framework

Noice & Toit LLP maintains a structured Delegation of Authority framework designed to balance operational efficiency with robust financial oversight. Every expenditure incurred on behalf of the firm must be reviewed and approved by an authorized manager before reimbursement or invoice settlement can take place.

Our approval hierarchy ensures that spending decisions are evaluated by individuals with direct visibility into practice group budgets, client billing arrangements, and firm-wide fiscal targets.

3.2 Approval Tiers and Limits

The approval matrix is based on the total monetary value of an individual expense report:

3.2.1 Tier 1: Up to €1,000 / \$1,000

- **Authorized Approver:** Direct Line Manager or Engagement Manager.
- **Scope:** Routine local travel, day-to-day client dining, standard office supplies, and short domestic trips.
- **Review Criteria:** Verification of receipts, confirmation that charges align with project scope, and adherence to daily per diem caps.

3.2.2 Tier 2: €1,001 to €5,000 / \$1,001 to \$5,000

- **Authorized Approver:** Department Director, Practice Group Leader, or Partner-in-Charge.
- **Scope:** Multi-day domestic travel, regional client audits, group team events, and cross-border European transit.
- **Review Criteria:** Budget availability, client cost recovery terms, and overall travel proportionality.

3.2.3 Tier 3: Over €5,000 / \$5,000

- **Authorized Approver:** Practice Vice President and Head of Global Finance.
- **Scope:** Intercontinental client engagements, major conference sponsorships, high-value technical procurement, and extended overseas assignments.
- **Review Criteria:** Strategic necessity, senior partner alignment, and executive committee compliance.

DO Route reports to the manager funding the expenditure

When submitting your expense claim, confirm that the routing destination corresponds to the budget owner responsible for the project code. If your trip was funded by another practice group, route the report to that group's lead manager.

DON'T Self-approve your own claims

Under no circumstances may an individual approve their own expense claim, regardless of corporate title, seniority, or equity partner status. Even Managing Partners must have their expense claims approved by the Audit Committee Chair or Chief Operating Officer.

3.3 Pre-Approval Requirements for Exceptional Travel

Certain high-cost or high-risk activities require written authorization before travel is booked or commitments are made with vendors.

DO Secure written pre-approval before booking high-value travel

Obtain written confirmation (via email or ticketing workflow) from your Practice Leader before booking international flights, team offsites, or any purchase exceeding €2,500 / \$2,500. State in the submission note who approved the purchase and in what role (for example, “pre-approved by the Head of Engineering”). Finance accepts this statement at face value and verifies it in retrospective audits.

DON'T Commit firm resources without prior sign-off

Do not sign agreements with venues, caterers, or travel agencies without prior budget approval. Commitments entered into without pre-approval may be rejected, leaving the individual personally liable for deposits or cancellation charges.

3.4 Reviewer Duties and Verification Standards

Approving managers bear personal responsibility for the integrity of the claims they endorse. Managers should never treat expense approval as a rubber-stamp administrative formality.

3.4.1 Checklist for Approving Managers

Before clicking the digital approval button in the Expense Portal, every reviewing manager must verify:

- **Legitimacy:** Does the expense support a genuine business requirement of Noice & Toit LLP or a billable client matter?
- **Completeness:** Are all receipts attached, fully itemized, legible, and matched to claim line items?
- **Policy Conformance:** Do hotel rates, meal costs, and travel classes comply with the limits set out in this handbook?
- **Allocation:** Are billable project codes, task numbers, and non-billable cost centers correctly assigned?
- **Exception Flagging:** Are any non-reimbursable items (such as minibar charges, alcohol on solo meals, spa treatments, or excess tips) properly removed or deducted following the calculation steps in Chapter 2?

3.5 Out-of-Office and Delegation Rules

When an approving manager is away on annual leave, extended medical leave, or intense trial commitments:

- The manager must set up a formal delegation delegate in the Expense Portal before departing.
- Approvals may only be delegated to peers of equal seniority or to an immediate superior. Delegating approval authority downward to direct reports is strictly prohibited.
- Temporary delegations expire automatically after thirty days unless renewed in writing through People Operations.

3.6 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What happens if an expense report is rejected by my manager?

A: If an approver rejects a report, the portal sends an automated notification with the manager's written feedback. You can edit line items, attach missing receipts, update cost centers, and re-submit the report directly through the workflow.

Q: Can an approving manager approve part of a report and reject part of it?

A: Yes. Managers can approve valid lines and place contentious lines on hold or adjust them downward. Approved items move directly to payment, while flagged lines return to the employee for explanation or correction.

Q: How long does manager review typically take?

A: Managers are expected to review pending expense reports within five business days of submission. If a report sits unreviewed for more than seven business days, the Expense Portal escalates it automatically to the next management level.

4 Air Travel Guidelines

4.1 Commercial Air Travel Principles

Air travel constitutes one of the largest single budget lines across Noice & Toit LLP. Flying is often necessary to conduct client discovery sessions, deliver high-stakes litigation arguments, or participate in executive steering committees across continents.

Our policy balances employee health, safety, and productivity with our partnership's duty to manage travel costs responsibly. Airline bookings should be made through our designated corporate travel management portal, which provides direct corporate discounts, duty of care tracking, and centralized billing. Tickets purchased directly from an airline remain reimbursable under the rules below when submitted with the airline's e-ticket receipt or itinerary invoice.

4.2 Advance Booking Expectations

Airfares fluctuate wildly based on capacity, seasonality, and booking lead time. Last-minute bookings represent an unnecessary drain on partnership resources. Finance compares the ticket issue date printed on the e-ticket receipt with the departure date of the first segment.

DO Book flights at least 14 days in advance

Plan your travel early and reserve flights at least fourteen calendar days prior to domestic travel and twenty-one calendar days prior to international flights. Advance booking ensures access to competitive economy inventory.

DON'T Book inside the seven-day window without a stated reason

A ticket issued fewer than seven calendar days before departure is reimbursable only if the submission note states the business reason that prevented earlier booking (a client meeting scheduled at short notice, a court date moved, an urgent site incident). Without a stated reason, the entire ticket is rejected.

4.3 Cabin Class Policies and Travel Thresholds

Our cabin class policy is governed by scheduled flight duration. Finance reads the cabin class and the scheduled departure and arrival times from the e-ticket itinerary.

4.3.1 Standard Economy Class

Economy class is the default for all flights. It is mandatory for domestic flights and for any flight segment with a scheduled duration under eight (8) hours.

4.3.2 Premium Economy

Premium Economy is permitted for segments with a scheduled duration of six (6) hours or more.

4.3.3 Long-Haul Business Class Exception

Business class is permitted on a segment only when one of the following holds:

- The scheduled segment duration strictly exceeds eight (8) hours, or
- The submission note states that the traveler had to conduct a documented client presentation or court hearing within four (4) hours of scheduled arrival without an intervening rest night.

DON'T Fly business on short-haul routes

A business class segment that satisfies neither condition makes the entire ticket non-reimbursable, because the e-ticket shows no separate economy fare that Finance could reimburse instead. Employees who want more comfort on short flights must buy the upgrade privately on a split invoice.

DON'T Book First Class under any circumstance

First Class travel is strictly prohibited across all routes, regardless of flight length, seniority, or client billing status. Any ticket containing a First Class segment is rejected in full.

4.4 Taxes, Surcharges, and Ancillary Fees

Airline e-tickets itemize government taxes, airport charges, and carrier surcharges separately from the base fare. Finance treats each fee line as follows:

DO Claim mandatory taxes and carrier surcharges

Government air transport taxes, passenger service charges, security fees, and carrier-imposed fuel or distribution surcharges are part of the ticket price and are fully reimbursable. So is one standard checked bag fee per traveler when the itinerary spans more than two calendar days between the first departure and the last arrival.

DON'T Expense seat selection or priority perks

Seat selection fees, extra-legroom seats, priority boarding, fast-track security, lounge access, and onboard Wi-Fi charges listed on the e-ticket are deducted from the claim. A second or third checked bag, and any checked bag on a trip of two days or less, is likewise deducted.

4.5 Flight Changes and Unused Tickets

Business schedules change rapidly, but ticket alterations must be managed with care:

- **Change fees:** A rebooking or change fee shown on the e-ticket is reimbursable when the note states the client or court reason for the change. Changes made for personal convenience are deducted.
- **Unused Ticket Credits:** When a non-refundable flight is canceled for business reasons, the resulting airline credit belongs to Noice & Toit LLP. The employee must track this credit and apply it to their next business journey.
- **Flight Disruption Assistance:** In the event of severe weather cancellations or carrier delays, contact the 24/7 Noice & Toit Travel Assistance Desk for rebooking support.

4.6 Airport Time, Lounges, and Productivity

Partners occasionally argue that lounge access pays for itself in billable hours. The Audit Committee has heard this argument in 2016, 2019, and 2022 and has rejected it each time, most recently by a vote of six to one. The dissenting member was traveling at the time. Lounge fees remain personal. Employees who need a quiet place to work at an airport are reminded that most terminals have a chapel.

4.7 In-Flight Connectivity

Onboard Wi-Fi has improved considerably since the days when a single e-mail attachment could occupy the Atlantic crossing. It remains a personal convenience for policy purposes: onboard Wi-Fi charges are deducted whether they appear on the e-ticket or on a separate receipt. Download your materials before boarding.

4.8 Sustainable Aviation

Noice & Toit LLP is committed to reducing corporate carbon emissions by 30% by 2030, a target the Sustainability Working Group describes as “ambitious but achievable” and the Travel Desk describes as “ambitious”. Before booking, assess whether video conferencing achieves the same outcome, and for regional European and US Northeast corridor routes evaluate high-speed rail first (see Chapter 5). Corporate bookings automatically include carbon offset contributions funded centrally; offset fees printed on an e-ticket are reimbursable.

Employees who take the train instead of flying on a route under four hours may note this in the report. The note has no financial effect, but the Sustainability Working Group reads them and, once a year, sends a small reusable cup to the most consistent rail traveler in each office. The cup is not an expense.

4.9 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can I keep frequent flyer miles and airline status points earned on business flights?

A: Yes. Employees may retain airline frequent flyer miles and loyalty perks for personal use. However, you may not select a more expensive flight, inconvenient layover, or non-preferred carrier simply to earn loyalty points on a specific airline.

Q: The e-ticket shows a return flight two weeks after the outbound. Is that a problem?

A: The gap itself is not. Whether nights between the flights are reimbursable is decided per night under Chapter 6 and Figure 1. The flight is reimbursable as long as cabin class and booking window comply.

Q: What happens if an airline involuntarily bumps me and offers cash compensation?

A: Denied-boarding compensation belongs to the traveler, provided accepting it does not cause the traveler to miss client commitments or incur extra hotel costs for the firm. Vouchers for future travel, however, must be used for firm travel.

Q: The airline charged me for a bag that turned out to be under the free allowance. Now what?

A: Claim the fee as printed on the e-ticket. Disputes with the airline are between you and the airline; if a refund arrives later, notify Finance and it is offset against your next report.

Q: A colleague and I are on the same e-ticket. How do I claim it?

A: Submit the ticket once, name the second traveler in the note, and route the line to the budget owner. Finance evaluates each passenger’s segments individually under the same rules.

5 Ground Transportation and Rail

5.1 Transit Philosophy and Environmental Priorities

Ground transportation choices impact both partnership expenditure and our collective environmental footprint. Noice & Toit LLP prioritizes safe, reliable, and sustainable transit solutions. We encourage all personnel to utilize public transport networks where well-developed and safe, reserving taxis and rideshares for situations where time constraints or logistics demand them.

5.2 Rail Travel as the Preferred Regional Option

Modern rail transit often provides a faster, more productive journey than air travel when factoring in airport security queues and ground transfers.

DO Book train travel for journeys under four hours

Choose rail transit when traveling between well-connected metropolitan centers such as London to Paris, Frankfurt to Berlin, Zurich to Geneva, or New York to Washington DC. Trains offer uninterrupted productive work environments, power outlets, and downtown-to-downtown convenience.

DO Use standard second class as the default

Second Class (Standard Class) is the firm standard for rail travel and is reimbursed without further justification. First Class is permitted only when the scheduled journey between the origin and destination stations printed on the ticket exceeds four (4) hours. A First Class ticket on a shorter route is rejected in full, because the ticket shows no Second Class fare that Finance could reimburse instead.

5.2.1 Seat Reservations and Flexible Fares

Seat reservation fees and flexible (refundable or rebookable) fares are reimbursable in full. Travelers should choose saver fares when the schedule is firm, but Finance does not deduct the difference.

5.2.2 Rail Season Passes and Transit Cards

If your project requires daily or weekly regional rail travel, request a temporary regional travel card (such as a German BahnCard, Swiss Half-Fare card, or UK Season ticket) through the Travel Desk. Finance will reimburse the pass cost if the projected ticket savings exceed the card purchase price.

5.3 City Transit, Taxis, and Ride-Hailing

Public transit systems (subways, underground networks, trams, and airport express trains) are the preferred mode of city travel across London, Berlin, New York, Zurich, and Singapore.

DO Use public transit when practical and safe

Use airport express rail links (such as the Heathrow Express, Berlin FEX, or JFK AirTrain) and city subway lines for routine travel between hotels, offices, and client locations. Upload ticket stubs or contactless payment receipts to your expense report.

DO Take standard taxis or ride-shares when justified

A taxi or standard ride-hailing fare (UberX, Lyft Standard, FreeNow, licensed street taxis) is reimbursable in full when either the fare before tip is **€25.00 / \$30.00 / £22.00 or less**, or the pickup or drop-off is an airport or long-distance rail station, or the submission note states one of the following justifications:

- Transporting bulky presentation displays, trial bundles, or heavy client equipment.
- Travel after 21:00 or before 06:00 local time (the receipt time governs).
- Consecutive offsite meetings where public transit would cause schedule failure.
- Several employees sharing one vehicle, making it cheaper than individual transit tickets.

A fare above the threshold that satisfies none of these is reimbursed up to the threshold and the excess is deducted.

DON'T Book premium or luxury rideshare categories

Never order premium rideshare tiers such as Uber Black, Uber Lux, Lyft Lux, or private chauffeur services. Where the receipt identifies a premium tier, the fare is reimbursed up to the unjustified-ride threshold above and the excess is deducted.

5.3.1 Tips on Taxi Fares

Taxi tips follow the Global Tipping Standards in Chapter 14, calculated on the fare before tip: up to 20% in Germany and in the United States and Canada, up to 10% elsewhere in the European Union and in Switzerland, nothing in Japan, South Korea, Singapore, or Hong Kong. Tip amounts above the local cap are deducted.

5.4 Rental Cars

Rental cars should be considered only when public transit, rail, and rideshare options are unavailable, or when visiting multiple rural client sites in a single day. Employees must book rental cars through our corporate portal with preferred partners (Hertz, Enterprise, National). The authorized booking class is **Compact** or **Intermediate**; electric or hybrid vehicles in those classes are encouraged. Full-size vehicles, SUVs, and luxury sedans require the approving Practice Leader to be named in the note.

DO Refuel the vehicle before returning it

Always refuel the vehicle at a standard petrol station before returning it to the rental depot. Rental car agency refueling charges include substantial markup fees. Keep the itemized fuel receipt to claim reimbursement.

DON'T Accept optional prepaid fuel or navigation packages

Do not purchase optional prepaid fuel packages, satellite navigation add-ons, or satellite radio subscriptions. Modern smartphones provide comprehensive navigation without extra rental fees.

5.5 Fuel Receipts

Fuel is reimbursed only for rental or firm pool vehicles. Fuel for a personal vehicle is never reimbursed; personal vehicle usage is compensated through the mileage allowance below, which already covers fuel.

DO Identify the rental vehicle in the note

When submitting a petrol station receipt, state in the note that the fuel was for a rental or pool vehicle and name the trip or client site. The fuel line (liters multiplied by price per liter) is then reimbursed in full. Commercial EV charging receipts are treated the same way.

DON'T Claim non-fuel items from the petrol station shop

Coffee, snacks, drinks, car washes, windscreen fluid, and any other shop items printed on a fuel receipt are deducted. If the note does not identify a rental or pool vehicle, Finance treats the vehicle as personal and rejects the fuel receipt in full.

5.6 Personal Vehicle Usage and Mileage Reimbursement

Employees may use their personal vehicles for approved business travel when other transit forms are impractical. Mileage is claimed through the portal's mileage log, not with fuel receipts.

DO Log business mileage accurately

Reimbursement for personal vehicle usage is calculated at fixed statutory rates:

- **European Union:** €0.38 per kilometer.
- **United States:** \$0.67 per mile (IRS conforming rate).
- **United Kingdom:** £0.45 per mile up to 10,000 miles per tax year.

This rate covers all fuel, oil, regular maintenance, tire wear, insurance coverage, and vehicle depreciation. To claim mileage, provide a log listing the date, departure address, destination address, client matter, and verified map distance.

DON'T Claim personal commuting miles

Never claim mileage or transit fares for daily travel between your home residence and your regular assigned office. Commuting is a personal living expense under statutory tax law and cannot be reimbursed or deducted by the firm.

5.6.1 Collision Damage and Rental Insurance

- **Within North America:** Decline optional Collision Damage Waiver (CDW) and Loss Damage Waiver (LDW) when renting with the corporate credit card, as comprehensive coverage is provided centrally through our firm insurance program. Optional waivers that appear on a rental invoice anyway are reimbursed; the Travel Desk will follow up with a gentle reminder.
- **International Rentals:** In European and Asian jurisdictions where statutory third-party liability and comprehensive insurance are not covered by corporate cards, select the standard mandatory CDW coverage at the rental counter.

5.7 A Word on Bicycles, Scooters, and Other Wheels

Shared bicycles and e-scooters are welcome for short hops between offices, stations, and client sites, and their app receipts are reimbursable like public transit. Helmets are strongly encouraged and not reimbursable. The Berlin office notes that the cobblestones of Prenzlauer Berg have ended more scooter journeys than any policy ever could.

5.8 Parking Fees, Tolls, and Congestion Charges

- **Reimbursable:** Business-related toll charges, municipal congestion charges (e.g., London Congestion Charge), public garage or airport long-term parking during multi-day assignments, and hotel parking for a rental or pool vehicle up to the nightly cap in Chapter 6.
- **Non-Reimbursable:** Traffic or parking citation penalties (Chapter 11), and parking for a personal vehicle at your regular office.

5.9 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: My taxi receipt does not show the pickup and drop-off addresses. Is it still valid?

A: Yes, provided it shows the operator, date, time, and fare. State the route in the note so Finance can apply the airport and rail station transfer rule.

Q: The taxi driver charged a waiting time or luggage surcharge. Is it reimbursable?

A: Yes. Metered surcharges printed on the receipt form part of the fare and are treated like the fare itself.

Q: What if I am involved in a traffic collision while driving a rental car on business?

A: First, ensure all parties are safe and notify local emergency services if necessary. Then immediately contact the rental agency emergency line and notify Noice & Toit Legal Operations within 24 hours so our corporate insurer can open a claim file.

6 Lodging and Hotel Accommodations

6.1 Corporate Lodging Philosophy

Noice & Toit LLP partners with leading international hotel groups (including Marriott, Hyatt, and Accor) to provide comfortable, safe, and productive lodging for our professionals worldwide. Business travel can be physically demanding; our accommodations standard ensures employees enjoy secure, quiet, and well-located lodging without incurring extravagant costs.

Hotel accommodations should be booked through our corporate travel portal, which grants access to negotiated corporate rates, complimentary high-speed internet, and flexible cancellation terms. Stays booked elsewhere are reimbursed under the same caps.

6.2 Regional Nightly Room Rate Caps

Nightly room caps are established based on prevailing hotel market rates across our primary travel destinations. The cap applies to the room rate per night as printed on the folio, before municipal occupancy taxes and value-added tax (VAT) that the folio adds on top. The hotel's city, as shown in the folio header, determines the tier.

6.2.1 Tier 1: Major Financial and Global Metropolises

- **Cap:** Up to **€220.00 / \$250.00 / £190.00** per night.
- **Applicable Locations:** London, New York City, San Francisco, Zurich, Geneva, Paris, Tokyo, Singapore, and Hong Kong.

6.2.2 Tier 2: Established Regional Business Hubs

- **Cap:** Up to **€160.00 / \$180.00 / £140.00** per night.
- **Applicable Locations:** Berlin, Munich, Frankfurt, Hamburg, Amsterdam, Dublin, Chicago, Boston, Seattle, Toronto, Sydney, and Milan.

6.2.3 Tier 3: Secondary Cities and Regional Markets

- **Cap:** Up to **€120.00 / \$140.00 / £105.00** per night.
- **Applicable Locations:** All other cities, university towns, suburban office parks, and provincial destinations.

During declared trade-fair and congress weeks, the event surcharge caps in Chapter 9 override the tier caps above for the host city. The override applies only when the submission note names the listed event and the night falls within the event window stated there.

DO Stay within regional lodging caps

Select standard rooms within the designated nightly cap for your destination city. When a nightly rate exceeds the cap, Finance reimburses the cap for that night and deducts the excess. VAT the folio charges on the excess is deducted as well. Municipal city tax is reimbursed in full regardless of the room rate.

DON'T Book suites, lofts, or upgraded room categories at firm expense

Room categories such as "Deluxe", "Executive", "Suite", "Loft", or "Atelier" are not prohibited as such, but they receive no higher cap. Whatever the room is called, the nightly rate is reimbursed only up to the tier cap. Complimentary upgrades granted by the hotel are welcome as long as the folio rate stays within the cap.

6.3 Folio Substantiation and Incidental Auditing

When checking out of a hotel, always obtain an itemized checkout folio. Do not rely on initial booking confirmations, prepayment receipts, or mobile app summaries. The final checkout folio is essential because it details every individual charge posted to your room account during your stay.

DO Scrutinize your checkout folio

Confirm that the room rate matches your booking, that local taxes are itemized, and that the folio shows the hotel's VAT registration number. Finance evaluates every incidental line individually under the rules in this chapter; you may enter the reduced net amount yourself to speed up settlement.

DON'T Claim hotel minibar, movie, wellness, or pet charges

The following folio lines are deducted in full, together with the VAT the folio charges on them: in-room minibar snacks and beverages of any kind (alcoholic or not), pay-per-view movies and streaming, spa treatments and massages, fitness or wellness surcharges, in-room gaming, pet or animal cleaning fees, and late check-out or early check-in fees.

6.3.1 City Taxes, Resort Fees, and Mandatory Levies

Mandatory municipal hotel occupancy taxes and tourism levies (such as the Paris Taxe de Séjour or the Berlin City Tax) are fully reimbursable when itemized on the checkout folio. Mandatory resort or facility fees are reimbursable; optional amenity bundles or resort passes are deducted.

6.3.2 In-Room Dining and Hotel Breakfast

Room service meals and hotel restaurant charges posted to the folio are meals, not incidentals. They count toward the daily meal caps in Chapter 7 for the day they were consumed and follow the timing and alcohol rules in Figure 2. A hotel breakfast line is reimbursable up to the breakfast cap in Chapter 7.

6.4 Laundry and Dry Cleaning

Maintaining clean business attire is necessary on longer assignments, but laundry services should be used sensibly. Both rules below refer to a single stay as shown by the folio's check-in and check-out dates.

DO Expense laundry on long stays

On stays of more than five (5) nights, laundry and garment pressing services are reimbursable up to **€35.00 / \$40.00 / £30.00 per seven-day period**. Amounts above the cap are deducted.

DO Expense one garment rescue on short stays when the note explains it

On stays of five (5) nights or fewer, laundry, express dry cleaning, or spot cleaning is reimbursable only when the note states that business attire was soiled during the trip (a spill at a client lunch, a stain before a keynote) and only up to **€25.00 / \$30.00 / £22.00 per stay**. The excess is deducted. Without such a statement in the note, the entire laundry line is deducted.

6.5 Hotel Parking and EV Charging

DO Park a rental or pool vehicle at the hotel

Overnight hotel parking, including valet fees and EV charging surcharges bundled into the parking line, is reimbursable up to **€30.00 / \$35.00 / £26.00 per night** when the note identifies the rental or pool vehicle. The excess per night is deducted.

DON'T Park a personal vehicle at firm expense

When the note does not identify a rental or pool vehicle, Finance treats the vehicle as personal and deducts the parking line in full.

6.6 Weekend Nights and Personal Extensions

A hotel night is dated by the calendar day on which it begins (the night of Saturday to Sunday is a Saturday night). Nights that begin on a Saturday, Sunday, or public holiday are reimbursed only under the branches of

Figure 1 in Chapter 13. Nights outside the weekend are evaluated under this chapter alone. Personal extension days added to a business trip are the employee's own cost (Chapter 9).

6.7 Hotel Loyalty Programs

Employees may participate in hotel loyalty programs and keep the points earned on business stays. Elite status often brings complimentary upgrades, late check-out, or breakfast, and the firm is happy for you to enjoy them, provided the folio bills only the standard rate. Do not choose a hotel above the cap for the sake of status nights. The Zurich office's long-running informal competition for the highest loyalty tier is not endorsed by Finance but has, to date, cost the firm nothing.

6.8 Safety and Duty of Care

Book hotels in safe, well-lit areas close to the client site or a major transit hub. In unfamiliar cities, prefer properties recommended by the Travel Desk. If you feel unsafe at a property, move: a second folio for the same night is reimbursed under the ordinary caps when the note explains the situation, and nobody at Finance will ask twice.

6.9 Extended Stays

When an assignment requires an employee to remain in a client city for more than fourteen (14) consecutive calendar days, work with the Noice & Toit Travel Desk to evaluate serviced apartment providers. Serviced apartment invoices are evaluated against the same nightly caps, divided by the number of nights.

6.10 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: The folio shows a higher rate on one night because of a trade fair. Is that night capped too?

A: Finance applies the cap per night. When the stay overlaps one of the declared trade-fair and congress weeks listed in Chapter 9 and the note names the event, the event surcharge cap in Chapter 9 replaces the tier cap for the nights within the event window. If a client contract explicitly authorizes higher lodging thresholds, state the client matter and the approving Practice Director in the note; Finance then reimburses the folio rate for that stay.

Q: The folio lists a "Deluxe Executive Loft" at €195 in Berlin. What do I get back?

A: Berlin is Tier 2 with a €160 cap. You receive €160 per night plus the city tax and the VAT attributable to the €160, less any deducted incidentals.

Q: Is bottled water in the room reimbursable?

A: No. Anything posted as a minibar charge is deducted, including water, soft drinks, and snacks.

7 Daily Meals and Travel Per Diems

7.1 The Individual Meal Allowance Framework

When traveling away from your regular office city on approved firm business, Noice & Toit LLP reimburses actual, necessary meal expenditures up to daily limits. Our philosophy focuses on providing wholesome, nourishing meals that support professional stamina while avoiding wasteful extravagance.

Reimbursement is based on actual itemized receipts rather than flat cash allowances, in compliance with international tax regimes. This chapter governs meals eaten alone. Meals with colleagues, clients, or candidates are governed by Figure 2 in Chapter 13, which also sets the alcohol allowances for each dining category.

7.2 Daily Meal Allowance Caps

Daily meal thresholds are calibrated to reflect realistic business dining costs in metropolitan business centers. The limits cover food, non-alcoholic beverages, applicable sales taxes, and reimbursable gratuities:

7.2.1 Individual Meal Thresholds

- **Breakfast:** Up to €15.00 / \$18.00 / £13.00.
- **Lunch:** Up to €25.00 / \$30.00 / £22.00.
- **Dinner:** Up to €45.00 / \$55.00 / £38.00.
- **Maximum Daily Aggregate Cap:** €85.00 / \$100.00 / £73.00 across all meals and snacks on one calendar day.

7.2.2 Which Cap Applies

The receipt time determines the meal category. A receipt timed before 11:00 is breakfast, from 11:00 to 15:59 is lunch, and from 16:00 onward is dinner. Where a restaurant bill lists a number of guests, the number of guests on the bill governs whether the meal is solo or group dining, unless the note states a different attendee count.

DO Stay within daily meal spending caps

Select quality, casual business dining that fits within our caps. After all deductions in this chapter, the remaining bill is reimbursed up to the cap for the meal category; the excess is deducted.

DON'T Roll over unspent meal allowances

Unspent meal allowances cannot be accumulated, carried over into subsequent days, or converted into cash reimbursements. If you spend €10 on lunch, your dinner cap remains €45.00, not €60.00.

7.3 Alcohol on Individual Solo Travel

Noice & Toit LLP maintains an unambiguous, firm-wide policy regarding alcoholic beverages consumed during individual travel.

DON'T Claim alcoholic beverages during solo dining

Alcoholic beverages (beer, wine, cocktails, cider, spirits, and mixed drinks containing spirits) consumed while dining alone are strictly non-reimbursable. Finance deducts each alcoholic line at its gross price, plus any tax the receipt adds on top of it, before applying the meal cap. Non-alcoholic beer, mocktails, and 0% ABV drinks are ordinary beverages.

7.3.1 Auditing and Line-Item Reductions

Finance reads every itemized line and recognizes alcohol by name (e.g., “IPA”, “Merlot”, “Pilsner”, “Highball”, “Spritz”, “Wein”, “Sake”). If a summary card slip is submitted instead of an itemized bill, Finance cannot verify the absence of alcohol and rejects the line under Chapter 2.

7.4 Gratuities, Service Charges, and Local Tipping Norms

Tipping practices vary substantially across global jurisdictions. Gratuities are reimbursable when they align with local customs. The tip cap is calculated on the bill total before tip (subtotal plus any taxes the receipt adds on top), and the tip amount above the cap is deducted. Where the tip is not printed on the receipt, no tip is reimbursed.

7.4.1 North American Norms (United States and Canada)

- In restaurants with table service, tips of up to 20% of the pre-tip bill are reimbursable.
- For counter service, takeout, and delivery, tips above \$1.00 are deducted.

7.4.2 European and United Kingdom Norms

- In European Union countries and Switzerland, menu prices legally include tax and service. Discretionary tips of up to 10% of the pre-tip bill are reimbursable; anything above 10% is deducted.
- Germany is a country-specific exception to this regional norm: see the Global Tipping Standards in Chapter 14, whose country-specific rows override these regional norms.
- In the United Kingdom, where an optional service charge (typically 12.5%) is printed on the bill, that service charge is reimbursable and any additional tip is deducted. Where no service charge is printed, a tip of up to 12.5% is reimbursable.
- Takeaway, counter service, and delivery orders anywhere in Europe carry no reimbursable tip.

7.4.3 Asian and Middle Eastern Norms

- In Japan, South Korea, Singapore, and Hong Kong, tipping is not customary. Any tip is deducted. A mandatory 10% service charge printed on the bill is reimbursable.

7.5 Luxury Ingredients and the Truffle Rule

7.5.1 A Brief History

In the autumn of 2019, a three-person client dinner in Milan produced a bill on which a single risotto accounted for more than the combined airfare of the attendees. The dish was, by all accounts, excellent. The ensuing correspondence between the hosting partner, the Milan office administrator, the Head of Global Finance, and eventually the Audit Committee ran to forty-one e-mails, two of which contained photographs of the risotto. The Audit Committee concluded that the firm had no principled objection to truffles, only to the absence of a principle. Version 3.0 of this handbook introduced the Truffle Policy in response, and it has survived every subsequent revision unchanged in substance, if not in the volume of internal jokes it generates.

7.5.2 The Rule

The firm has no objection to good food, but certain ingredients turn a business meal into a tasting event. Dishes featuring truffle are evaluated under the Truffle Policy Flowchart, Figure 3 in Chapter 13, before any meal cap is applied. A dish that fails the flowchart is deducted at its gross line price like any other non-reimbursable item. The flowchart applies equally to solo meals, team dinners, and client hospitality.

7.6 Working Late and Overtime Meals

When required to work in your regular office or home workspace past 20:30 on urgent client deliverables, you may claim one dinner or delivery order up to **€20.00 / \$25.00 / £18.00**, provided the note states that you were working late and names the matter. Alcohol is deducted as on any solo meal. Without such a statement, a restaurant receipt in your home office city is not a travel meal and is rejected.

7.7 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can I buy snacks or coffee between meals?

A: Incidental coffee, tea, and snack purchases during travel are allowable, provided the cumulative cost of all breakfast, lunch, dinner, and snacks remains within the daily aggregate cap.

Q: The restaurant bill has no time printed on it. Which cap applies?

A: Finance applies the dinner cap if the note describes a dinner, otherwise the lunch cap.

Q: I ordered a non-alcoholic cocktail. Is it deducted?

A: No. Only beverages containing alcohol are deducted. Where the receipt makes the alcohol content ambiguous (a “Spritz” without further description), Finance treats it as alcoholic.

Q: I paid for a colleague’s lunch on my card. Is that a solo meal?

A: No. State the colleague and the occasion in the note; the bill is evaluated as an internal team meal under Figure 2.

Q: Does truffle oil count as truffle?

A: Figure 3 lists truffle oil explicitly. Whether a given bottle has ever been near a truffle is a question for the culinary press, not for Finance.

Q: Is caviar governed by the Truffle Policy?

A: No. Caviar, wagyu, lobster, and similar ingredients are governed only by the ordinary caps in this chapter and Figure 2. The Audit Committee has so far declined three proposals to extend Figure 3 to further ingredients, on the grounds that one flowchart per ingredient is not a scalable governance model.

Q: I am vegetarian and the conference lunch was a sausage buffet. Can I eat elsewhere?

A: Yes. Meals eaten at a restaurant during a conference are evaluated under the ordinary caps; the existence of conference catering does not change the outcome. Mention the dietary reason in the note if you like, but it is not required.

8 Client Entertainment and Hospitality

8.1 Building Client Relationships with Integrity

At Noice & Toit LLP, cultivating enduring relationships with corporate clients, joint venture partners, and prospective talent is essential to our partnership's long-term success. Business hospitality, client lunches, and hosted dinners offer valuable opportunities to discuss strategic matters, review ongoing engagements, and celebrate milestone achievements in a relaxed, professional setting.

However, business entertainment carries heightened financial, reputational, and regulatory exposure. Client hospitality must always be purposeful, moderate, and fully transparent. It must never give the appearance of impropriety, conflict of interest, or inducement.

8.2 Documenting Legitimate Business Purpose

Tax authorities and client procurement teams routinely scrutinize business entertainment deductions. To withstand audit scrutiny, every hosted meal claimed on an expense report must be substantiated in the submission note.

DO State the business purpose and the attendee composition

The note for every group meal must state:

- The business purpose (the client matter, the contract milestone, the interview round, the project review).
- The external organization(s) whose representatives attended, or the fact that all attendees were firm employees.
- The total number of attendees including yourself, and how many of them were external guests.

The itemized restaurant bill showing all food and beverage lines remains mandatory.

DON'T Submit vague or undocumented entertainment claims

A group bill whose note lacks the business purpose or the attendee count is evaluated as a solo meal under Chapter 7: the solo caps apply and all alcohol is deducted. Notes such as "dinner with contacts" or "business lunch" do not satisfy the requirement.

8.3 Dining Categories

Figure 2 in Chapter 13 recognizes three dining categories, each with its own per-person spend cap and alcohol allowance:

- **Solo employee dining:** One employee eating alone (Chapter 7).
- **Internal team meal:** Two or more firm employees with no external guests. Includes project milestone dinners, onsite team lunches, and interview panel debriefs.
- **Client hospitality:** At least one external guest. External guests include clients, prospective clients, joint venture partners, suppliers, and job candidates being interviewed or recruited.

Where the note states the attendee count, Finance divides the reimbursable bill by that count to check the per-person cap. Where only the restaurant's guest count is printed on the bill, that count is used.

8.4 The Decision Framework for Hospitality and Alcohol

Unlike individual solo travel, where all alcohol is strictly non-reimbursable, corporate hospitality involves more nuanced considerations regarding group composition and beverage allowances.

Rather than providing fragmented written descriptions that lead to ambiguity and audit disputes, Noice & Toit LLP centralizes all rules governing group dining, attendee ratios, alcohol allowances, and late-night expenditures into a single, authoritative visual decision matrix.

DO Consult the visual matrix before hosting

All spending limits, required internal-to-external attendee ratios, allowable alcohol percentages, and late-night cutoffs are established exclusively in Figure 2: Dining and Entertainment Decision Matrix in Chapter 13. Dishes featuring truffle are additionally screened under Figure 3.

DON'T Rely on assumptions or verbal manager promises

Casual verbal approval from a colleague does not override the visual standards. If a hospitality claim exceeds the thresholds set out in Figure 2, Finance reduces the reimbursement to the threshold or deducts the offending lines.

8.5 Entertainment Venues, Sports, and Cultural Events

Client entertainment should generally take place at professional dining establishments, private dining rooms, or business clubs. Entertaining at other types of venues requires additional caution:

8.5.1 Sporting Events and Theater Performances

Tickets for theater performances, concerts, or sporting matches attended together with clients are reimbursable only when the note names the client organization and the host employee attended. Tickets must be in standard seating tiers; luxury suites, VIP hospitality boxes, and backstage passes are deducted.

8.5.2 Prohibited Entertainment Venues

Under no circumstances may firm funds be expended at night clubs, gentleman's clubs, casinos, or venues that conflict with our professional standards and inclusive workplace culture. Any bill from such an establishment is rejected in full and referred to the Ethics and Conduct Committee.

8.6 Internal Team Celebrations and Project Milestones

Recognizing team dedication following the closing of an intense transaction, litigation verdict, or year-end milestone is encouraged:

- The note must name the milestone, onsite, or review the meal belongs to, and state that the budget owner (Department Director or Practice Leader) pre-approved the event.
- Compliance with the internal dining parameters illustrated in Figure 2 (Chapter 13) is mandatory.
- Team-building activities other than meals (escape rooms, bowling, cooking classes) are governed by Chapter 10.

8.7 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What if a client insists on ordering an unusually expensive vintage wine?

A: While we aim to be gracious hosts, employees should guide wine selections toward standard business bottles. Review the beverage allowance in Figure 2 (Chapter 13). Alcohol above the allowance is deducted; the food is unaffected.

Q: Can I expense coffee or a meal when meeting a job candidate?

A: Yes. Recruiting meals are client hospitality under Figure 2. State the role being recruited for and the number of candidates in the note.

Q: We ordered takeaway for the whole team during an onsite. Is that a team meal?

A: Yes. State the onsite and the headcount in the note. The internal team caps in Figure 2 apply per person, and the takeaway tipping rule in Chapter 7 applies to any tip.

9 Weekends, Holidays, and Bleisure Travel

9.1 Weekend Travel Context and Governance

Business engagements at Noice & Toit LLP generally occur during regular business days from Monday morning through Friday evening. Travel schedules should be structured to allow professionals to return home for their personal weekends and public holidays whenever feasible.

However, complex multi-jurisdictional matters, international cross-border transactions, client audits, and trade conferences occasionally require travel over weekends or declared public holidays. Because weekend expenditures naturally blend business obligations with personal downtime, tax authorities and compliance auditors subject weekend claims to rigorous scrutiny.

9.2 The Weekend Approval Decision Logic

To ensure complete fairness and objective auditing across all practice groups, Noice & Toit LLP does not rely on subjective narrative rules for weekend reimbursement. Instead, all eligibility rules for Saturday, Sunday, and statutory holiday expenses are defined strictly within our centralized visual flowchart.

DO Evaluate weekend claims against the visual flowchart

Any receipt dated on a Saturday, Sunday, or declared public holiday, and any hotel night beginning on such a day, is governed exclusively by Figure 1: Weekend and Public Holiday Travel Approval Flowchart in Chapter 13. The facts the flowchart asks about (a conference or client delivery on that day, a Monday morning meeting) must be stated in the submission note.

DON'T Assume weekend stays are automatically reimbursed

Do not assume that an early Monday meeting or late Friday flight automatically justifies company reimbursement for an entire weekend. If your circumstance leads to a non-reimbursable branch in Figure 1, you must cover those costs personally.

9.2.1 What Counts as a Weekend Expense

- A **restaurant, taxi, or fuel receipt** is a weekend expense when its printed date falls on a Saturday, Sunday, or public holiday.
- A **hotel night** is a weekend expense when it begins on such a day (see Chapter 6). Weekday nights on the same folio are evaluated normally.
- A **flight or train ticket** is not a weekend expense merely because the travel day is a weekend; the ticket is evaluated under Chapters 4 and 5. Lodging and meals at the destination on that weekend are.
- **Commercial invoices** for goods (Chapter 10) are never weekend expenses.

9.3 Combining Business Travel with Personal Leisure (Bleisure)

Noice & Toit LLP supports employee well-being and recognizes that combining business journeys with personal leisure (often called “bleisure” travel) can be an enjoyable benefit of professional life. Employees are welcome to extend business trips over weekends or take personal vacation days in destination cities, provided this is done with absolute cost neutrality to the firm.

9.3.1 The Cost-Neutrality Principle

Personal extensions must impose zero incremental financial cost on Noice & Toit LLP or our billing clients:

- **Airfare:** A ticket whose dates include a personal extension is reimbursable as long as the note states the business dates and confirms that the fare did not exceed the direct business-only fare.
- **Lodging and Daily Expenses:** Hotel nights, local transit, meals, and incidentals on personal extension days are the exclusive responsibility of the employee. Where a folio covers such nights, Finance deducts them.

DON'T

Expense personal sightseeing or recreational activities

Never claim expenses for museum admissions, guided city tours, sporting event tickets, ski passes, beach equipment rentals, or cultural excursions, regardless of whether they take place during a weekend or on an extended business trip.

9.4 Family Members, Spouses, and Travel Companions

Partners, associates, and staff are welcome to have family members, spouses, or companions accompany them on business trips, subject to strict boundaries:

- All tickets, meals, and transit for accompanying companions must be paid privately. Restaurant bills that include a companion are evaluated with the companion excluded from the attendee count and their share deducted.
- If a companion shares a standard business hotel room, the firm covers the nightly rate up to the regional cap. Extra-person, rollaway, or double-occupancy surcharges on the folio are deducted.

9.5 International Travel and Transit Rest Days

On long-haul intercontinental journeys crossing more than six (6) time zones (London to Singapore, New York to Tokyo), travelers may arrange an arrival schedule that includes an overnight rest day before commencing formal client meetings. Whether such a night is reimbursable depends only on the day of the week: a weekday rest night is an ordinary hotel night under Chapter 6, a weekend rest night follows Figure 1. Jet lag is real, but it is not a branch in the flowchart.

9.6 Public Holidays Around the World

Which days count as public holidays is a surprisingly deep question in a firm with offices on three continents. For the purposes of Figure 1, a public holiday is a statutory holiday in the country where the expense was incurred, not in the employee’s home country. Whit Monday in Berlin is a holiday; Whit Monday in New York is a Monday. Employees are encouraged to check the destination calendar before assuming either.

9.7 Trade Fair and Congress Weeks

Hotel rates in trade-fair and congress cities surge during major events, and the ordinary tier caps in Chapter 6 can make a compliant booking impossible in those weeks. For the events listed below, Noice & Toit LLP therefore maintains event surcharge caps that override the regional tier caps in Chapter 6 and the appendix table in Chapter 14 for the host city concerned.

DO

Claim the event surcharge cap when your stay overlaps a listed event

When your hotel stay overlaps the window of one of the events below and your submission note names the event, each night falling within the event window is reimbursed up to the event surcharge cap instead of the city’s ordinary tier cap. All other lodging rules (incidentals, laundry, parking, city tax) are unchanged. Where the note names no listed event, or the stay falls outside the event window, the ordinary tier cap governs even if you attended the event.

City	Event	Event Window	Nightly Surcharge Cap
Berlin	FinTech Summit	March	€200.00 / \$225.00 / £175.00
Munich	Bauma construction fair	April	€200.00 / \$225.00 / £175.00
Hamburg	SMM Wind Energy	September	€200.00 / \$225.00 / £175.00
Frankfurt	Frankfurt Book Fair	October	€200.00 / \$225.00 / £175.00
Düsseldorf	Medica	November	€200.00 / \$225.00 / £175.00

9.8 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What if extending my stay over a Saturday night makes the return airfare significantly cheaper than a Friday departure?

A: If staying over a Saturday night reduces the round-trip airfare by more than the cost of one extra hotel night and one day of meals, the firm may cover the Saturday night hotel. State the fare saving and the approving Practice Leader in the note; without both, Figure 1 applies unchanged.

Q: My conference ran Thursday to Saturday. Is Saturday night reimbursable?

A: Follow Figure 1. The conference was on Saturday, so Saturday night is decided by the conference branch; name the conference in the note.

10 Office Supplies, Hardware, and Event Materials

10.1 Modern Workplace Technology and Supplies

At Noice & Toit LLP, our professionals work seamlessly across physical corporate offices, client sites, remote hotel hubs, and approved home working environments. Having dependable equipment, reliable connectivity, and essential stationery is critical to delivering top-tier professional services.

However, equipment, event materials, and digital subscriptions represent ongoing balance-sheet assets and carry data privacy, licensing, and IT security implications. This chapter governs commercial invoices for goods and services: what may be bought out of pocket, up to what amount, and what the submission note must state. It is organized by what was purchased; where an invoice mixes categories, each line is evaluated under its own category.

10.2 Routine Office Supplies and Stationery

Whenever possible, order stationery, paper, toner, notebooks, and writing materials through our central Office Services portal. For emergency, travel-related, or incidental purchases:

DO Purchase minor emergency supplies out of pocket

Incidental stationery, pens, notebooks, sticky notes, tape, printer paper, cables, and similar consumables may be expensed out of pocket up to **€50.00 / \$60.00 / £45.00 per invoice**. Amounts above the cap are deducted.

DON'T Stockpile office supplies through retail stores

Do not purchase bulk quantities of printer paper, high-end desk organizers, fountain pens, or leather folios out of pocket. Submit a requisition to Facilities and Office Services instead.

10.3 Computer Hardware and Digital Peripherals

All laptops, tablets, smartphones, and associated hardware must meet Noice & Toit Enterprise Information Security requirements. Laptops, tablets, and phones themselves are never purchased out of pocket; IT issues them.

DO Expense routine peripherals under the threshold

Peripherals and tools with a unit price under **€100.00 / \$120.00 / £90.00** (USB drives, travel mice, cables, adapters, hubs, soldering irons, hand tools, chargers) are reimbursable with an itemized invoice. A replacement charger or adapter bought while traveling is reimbursable up to €90.00 / \$100.00 when the note states that the original failed.

DO Cite the IT ticket for high-value peripherals

Peripherals with a unit price of **€100.00 / \$120.00 / £90.00 or more** (external monitors, mechanical keyboards, webcams, noise-canceling headsets, external SSDs, specialist test equipment) are reimbursable only when the note cites the IT Helpdesk ticket number under which IT cleared the purchase. Without a ticket number, that line is deducted.

DON'T Expense home office furniture, decor, or plants

Office chairs, standing desks, lamps, footrests, monitor arms, shelving, rugs, artwork, and any live or artificial plants (including plant rental, plant care, and “green wall” services) are Facilities budget items. They are deducted from expense reports regardless of purpose or pre-approval. Check the People portal for the regional remote-work ergonomic stipend.

10.4 Software Licenses, Cloud Infrastructure, and AI Services

Software tools, SaaS platforms, cloud environments, and generative AI APIs are increasingly utilized for research and productivity. Unvetted software presents legal, intellectual property, and client confidentiality risks.

DON'T Expense software subscriptions or AI model credits

Software licenses, cloud compute credits (AWS, GCP, Azure), SaaS productivity subscriptions, app store purchases, and generative AI API credits are deducted in full. Request them through the IT Service Portal, where IT reviews data protection agreements and provisions enterprise access.

10.5 Event, Marketing, and Workshop Materials

Conference booths, hackathons, client workshops, and onsite trainings routinely require materials that no central catalog stocks: booth displays, branded giveaways, demo props, signage, printed handouts, and consumables.

DO Expense event materials for a named event with stated pre-approval

Booth and display materials, promotional giveaways and team swag, workshop props and demonstration gear, signage, printing, and courier delivery of such items are reimbursable in full when the note (a) names the event, workshop, or campaign and (b) states that the budget owner (Department Director, Practice Leader, or equivalent) pre-approved the purchase. Both statements are required; if either is missing, the event material lines are deducted.

Event materials also include temporary staging and decor rented for the event venue, such as banners, backdrops, and rented plants, moss walls, and other greenery used as booth or stage decoration. This staging exception overrides the general plant exclusion in this chapter and in Chapter 11: greenery rented temporarily for a named, pre-approved event is an event material, while recurring office or home greenery remains a Facilities budget item.

DON'T Buy event materials that double as personal or office goods

Furniture, decor, apparel for personal use, and electronics above the peripheral threshold do not become reimbursable by being bought for an event. They remain governed by their own sections above. The same holds for plants, with the sole exception of temporary staging greenery rented for a named, pre-approved event under the card above: monthly office plant rental, permanent planting, and plant care for office greenery are Facilities budget items regardless of purpose or pre-approval.

10.5.1 A Note on Rubber Ducks and Other Icons

The firm's tolerance for unusual event materials has a history. The 2021 Hamburg hackathon booth, staffed by a team that had ordered a crate of squeaky ducks as a load-testing mascot, generated more qualified leads than any booth before or since. The ducks are now something of a tradition, and Finance has stopped asking why. This does not mean that anything bought in bulk and painted yellow is an event material; it means that giveaways for a named, pre-approved event are.

10.6 Team-Building Activities

Activities such as escape rooms, cooking classes, bowling, or go-karting for a team are reimbursable up to **€50.00 / \$60.00 / £45.00 per participant** when the note states the occasion, the headcount, and the pre-approving budget owner. The excess is deducted. Meals during such events follow Figure 2.

10.7 Shipping, Courier, and Connectivity

- **Courier and postage** for client deliverables, trial bundles, or replacement equipment is reimbursable in full when the note states what was shipped.
- **Mobile data:** International roaming passes, travel eSIMs, and prepaid data bundles bought while traveling without a firm SIM are reimbursable up to **€50.00 / \$60.00 / £45.00 per trip**.

10.8 Professional Publications and Books

- **Books and Technical Reference Manuals:** Treatises, handbooks, and reference volumes required for active client engagements may be expensed up to **€80.00 / \$90.00 / £70.00 per item** when the note cites the project or client matter. The excess per item is deducted.
- **Professional Periodicals:** Subscriptions to the Financial Times, Wall Street Journal, Economist, or specialized legal journals must be ordered through Global Library and Information Services and are deducted from expense reports.

10.9 Ownership and Asset Tracking

Any piece of hardware, technical device, peripheral, or book purchased with firm funds or reimbursed through an expense report remains the exclusive property of Noice & Toit LLP:

- High-value hardware peripherals must be registered with the local office IT asset manager upon receipt.

- When leaving the firm, an employee must return all reimbursed equipment and devices alongside their firm-issued laptop and mobile phone.

10.10 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: We bought 400 rubber ducks as giveaways for a hackathon booth. Seriously?

A: Seriously. Giveaways for a named event are event materials. If the note names the hackathon and states who pre-approved the budget, the ducks are reimbursed in full.

Q: The invoice for our booth props also includes a rented ficus for the booth. What happens?

A: If the ficus is temporary staging rented for the named, pre-approved event, the staging exception above makes it an event material, and it is reimbursed with the props. Recurring office or conference-room greenery is not staging; that line is deducted, together with its share of VAT, and the invoice is partially approved.

Q: The vendor invoice is addressed to a client company rather than to the firm. Is it still valid?

A: The buyer name on a commercial invoice does not affect reimbursability, provided the employee paid it and the note explains the purchase.

11 Non-Reimbursable Expenses and Prohibited Purchases

11.1 The Boundary Between Business and Personal Life

Business travel and client advisory work inevitably blur the lines between professional duties and everyday personal living. However, tax authorities and partnership financial standards require a clear, consistent boundary. The firm reimburses only the incremental, necessary expenses caused directly by conducting business on behalf of Noice & Toit LLP.

Expenses that represent ordinary personal maintenance, leisure choices, discretionary upgrades, or the consequences of avoidable individual negligence are strictly the financial responsibility of the employee.

11.2 Master Catalog of Non-Reimbursable Expenditures

The following items are non-reimbursable across all offices, projects, and billing arrangements. Where such an item appears as one line on an otherwise valid receipt, that line is deducted (with its tax) under the calculation steps in Chapter 2. Where the entire receipt consists of such items, the receipt is rejected.

11.2.1 Legal Penalties, Fines, and Citations

DON'T Claim traffic tickets or legal citations

Speeding tickets, red-light camera fines, parking violation tickets, bus lane penalties, wheel clamping release fees, vehicle impound charges, and toll violation surcharges are strictly personal obligations. The firm will not reimburse any fine or citation under any circumstance, even if incurred while rushing to a client emergency.

11.2.2 Personal Grooming, Health, and Apparel

DON'T Expense haircuts, spa treatments, or clothing

The firm does not reimburse routine personal care expenditures, including:

- Haircuts, hair salon styling, blowouts, and manicures.
- Spa treatments, massages (including hotel “express” or “de-stress” massages), saunas, and beauty therapies.
- Suits, ties, shirts, dresses, shoes, belts, socks, and any other clothing, however urgently needed.
- Over-the-counter pharmaceuticals, vitamins, headache tablets, or sunscreen.
- Health club day-passes, gym drop-in fees, hotel fitness center surcharges, or fitness trainer sessions.

The only exception is the delayed-baggage allowance below.

11.2.3 Luggage, Bags, and Travel Accessories

- Luggage sets, suitcases, carry-on roller bags, garment bags, and briefcases.
- Passport renewal fees, tourist visa fees, and passport photo fees.
- Travel umbrellas, neck pillows, earplugs, sleep masks, and luggage tags.

11.2.4 Discretionary Upgrades and Luxury Preferences

- Business or First Class cabins where Chapter 4 does not permit them; First Class rail where Chapter 5 does not permit it.
- The portion of a hotel rate above the regional cap (Chapter 6).
- Rental car categories above Intermediate without a named approver (Chapter 5).
- Airline seat selection, extra-legroom seats, priority boarding, and lounge access (Chapter 4).
- Premium rideshare tiers above the unjustified-ride threshold (Chapter 5).

11.2.5 Hotel Incidentals

- Minibar snacks and beverages of any kind, in-room movies and streaming, spa and wellness charges, pet or animal cleaning fees, and late check-out fees (Chapter 6).
- Laundry outside the allowances in Chapter 6.

11.2.6 Gifts, Gift Cards, and Cash Equivalents

DON'T Purchase gift cards or retail vouchers

Retail gift cards, Amazon vouchers, prepaid debit cards, and cash equivalents are deducted wherever they appear. Tax regulations classify gift cards as cash compensation, triggering mandatory payroll tax withholding. Client gift initiatives and employee recognition programs must be coordinated through People Operations.

11.2.7 Family, Companion, and Pet Expenses

- Airfare, train tickets, meals, and transit fares for spouses, domestic partners, children, friends, or other travel companions.
- Pet boarding, kennel fees, dog walking services, hotel pet fees, and in-home pet care during business travel.
- Babysitting services, childcare fees, house-sitting fees, or home plant watering services.

11.2.8 Personal Subscriptions, Software, and Entertainment

- Streaming media services (Netflix, Spotify, Apple Music, Disney+, YouTube Premium) and consumer magazines.
- Software licenses, app purchases, cloud credits, and AI API credits (Chapter 10).
- Museum admissions, city tours, ski passes, and other recreational activities (Chapter 9).

11.2.9 Office Furnishing

- Furniture, lamps, decor, artwork, and plants, including plant rental and plant care services (Chapter 10). The sole exception is temporary staging greenery rented for a named, pre-approved event, which Chapter 10 treats as an event material.

11.2.10 Venues

- Any bill from a night club, gentleman's club, or casino (Chapter 8) is rejected in full.

11.3 Delayed or Lost Baggage Emergency Allowance

The only exception to the apparel and grooming exclusion occurs when an airline mishandles or loses an employee's checked bag on an outbound business flight:

- You may purchase essential toiletries and one modest change of business attire up to a cumulative **€100.00 / \$120.00 / £90.00**. The excess is deducted.
- The note must state that the airline lost or delayed the bag, name the flight, and quote the Property Irregularity Report (PIR) reference issued by the airline baggage desk. Without a PIR reference in the note, apparel and toiletries are deducted like any other personal item.
- No emergency apparel or toiletry reimbursement is permitted upon return to your home residence city.

11.4 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What if I received a parking ticket because the client office parking lot was full?

A: The ticket remains your personal responsibility. Plan parking in designated public lots or garages when client visitor parking is unavailable.

Q: Can I expense a hotel laundry bill if my suit was stained during a client dinner?

A: Possibly. Chapter 6 sets the conditions and the per-stay cap for garment rescue on short trips; the incident must be described in the note.

Q: I bought emergency socks at the airport before a client meeting. Reimbursable?

A: No, unless the airline lost your bag and the note quotes the PIR reference. Clothing is otherwise personal regardless of circumstance.

12 Multi-Currency Expenses and Foreign Exchange

12.1 Global Operations and Multi-Currency Reporting

Noice & Toit LLP operates across multiple currency zones. Our professionals regularly incur expenses denominated in Euros (EUR, €), United States Dollars (USD, \$), British Pounds (GBP, £), Swiss Francs (CHF), Singapore Dollars (SGD), Japanese Yen (JPY), and other world currencies.

Every receipt is evaluated in the currency printed on it, and reimbursement is paid in that currency where it is EUR, USD, or GBP. This chapter explains how caps and conversions work for other currencies.

12.2 Applying Caps to Foreign Receipts

All caps in this handbook are published in EUR, USD, and GBP. Finance applies the cap column that matches the receipt currency.

DO Convert caps for other currencies at the ECB reference rate

For a receipt in any other currency (CHF, SGD, JPY, and so on), Finance converts the **EUR** cap into the receipt currency using the European Central Bank (ECB) daily reference rate for the receipt date, applies the converted cap, and pays out the resulting amount converted back to EUR at the same rate. Employees do not need to perform any conversion themselves.

DON'T Mix currencies within one claim line

Do not enter a EUR amount for a receipt printed in USD, or vice versa. Enter the amount and currency exactly as printed; the portal performs any conversion.

12.3 Tipping Norms Follow the Vendor Country

The tipping caps in Chapters 7 and 14 depend on the country of the vendor as printed on the receipt, not on the currency or on the employee's home office. A receipt from a restaurant in Zurich follows the Swiss rule even if paid in EUR.

12.4 Good Practice at the Card Terminal

None of the following changes how a receipt is evaluated, but all of it saves the firm money over a year of travel:

DON'T Accept Dynamic Currency Conversion (DCC) at card terminals

When a foreign terminal offers to charge your card in your home currency, decline and pay in the local currency. Merchant DCC rates carry hidden markups of 5% to 12%. Finance reimburses the local-currency amount printed on the receipt either way, so accepting DCC only costs you.

- Avoid airport currency kiosks. If you need cash in a cash-preferred economy (Japan, parts of Germany), withdraw it from a bank-affiliated ATM.
- Keep foreign receipts flat. Thermal paper in a humid climate fades faster than the ECB updates its rates.
- The Singapore office maintains an informal list of restaurants that still add a 10% service charge and then present a tip line. Do not fill in the tip line.

12.5 Foreign Value Added Tax (VAT) Recovery

In many European and Asian jurisdictions, business expenditures (hotel accommodation, meals, conference fees) include Value Added Tax (VAT), Goods and Services Tax (GST), or similar consumption taxes:

- Under international tax treaties, Noice & Toit LLP can reclaim foreign VAT paid on business expenses, generating substantial annual recoveries for the partnership.
- To enable VAT recovery, hotel folios and commercial invoices must show the vendor's VAT registration number, the net amount, the applicable rate (e.g., 19% MwSt in Germany, 20% VAT in the UK), and the gross total. Restaurant, taxi, and fuel receipts are exempt from the registration number requirement.
- A hotel folio or commercial invoice that omits the vendor's VAT registration number is reimbursed net of the VAT shown, since the firm cannot recover it.

12.6 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: My card was charged in EUR for a receipt printed in CHF. Which amount do I claim?

A: Claim the CHF amount printed on the receipt. The firm reimburses at the ECB reference rate; small differences to your card statement are not reimbursed.

Q: Can I claim reimbursement for leftover foreign cash currency?

A: No. Unspent foreign currency bills and coins belong to the employee and cannot be "bought back" by the firm. Only actual, documented business expenditures are eligible for reimbursement.

13 Decision Flowcharts and Approval Diagrams

13.1 The Visual Decision Architecture

Certain operational expense categories involve conditional logic, multi-factor dependencies, and strict thresholds that cannot be adequately captured through static prose without introducing conflicting interpretations.

To maintain unambiguous standards across all offices and client engagements, Noice & Toit LLP mandates the use of visual decision flowcharts. The diagrams presented in this chapter serve as the exclusive binding authority for:

1. Weekend and statutory holiday travel eligibility determinations.
2. Group dining categories, per-person caps, and alcohol allowances.
3. Truffle and luxury-ingredient dishes on any restaurant bill.

DO Inspect the visual flowcharts directly

Review the decision branches in Figures 1, 2, and 3 carefully before committing funds or submitting your claim. To prevent conflicting interpretations, no written text summary of these decision branches is provided anywhere in this handbook. The visual graphics below are the sole source of binding policy for these scenarios.

DON'T Rely on text summaries or verbal exemptions

Do not search for alternative textual descriptions of weekend travel rules, dining caps, or the truffle rule. If a claim does not satisfy the visual decision tree, the claim is rejected or adjusted by Finance.

13.2 Weekend and Statutory Holiday Travel Approval Flowchart

All receipts dated on a Saturday, Sunday, or declared public holiday, and all hotel nights beginning on such a day, are audited strictly against the visual logic set forth in Figure 1. The facts the flowchart asks about must be stated in the submission note.

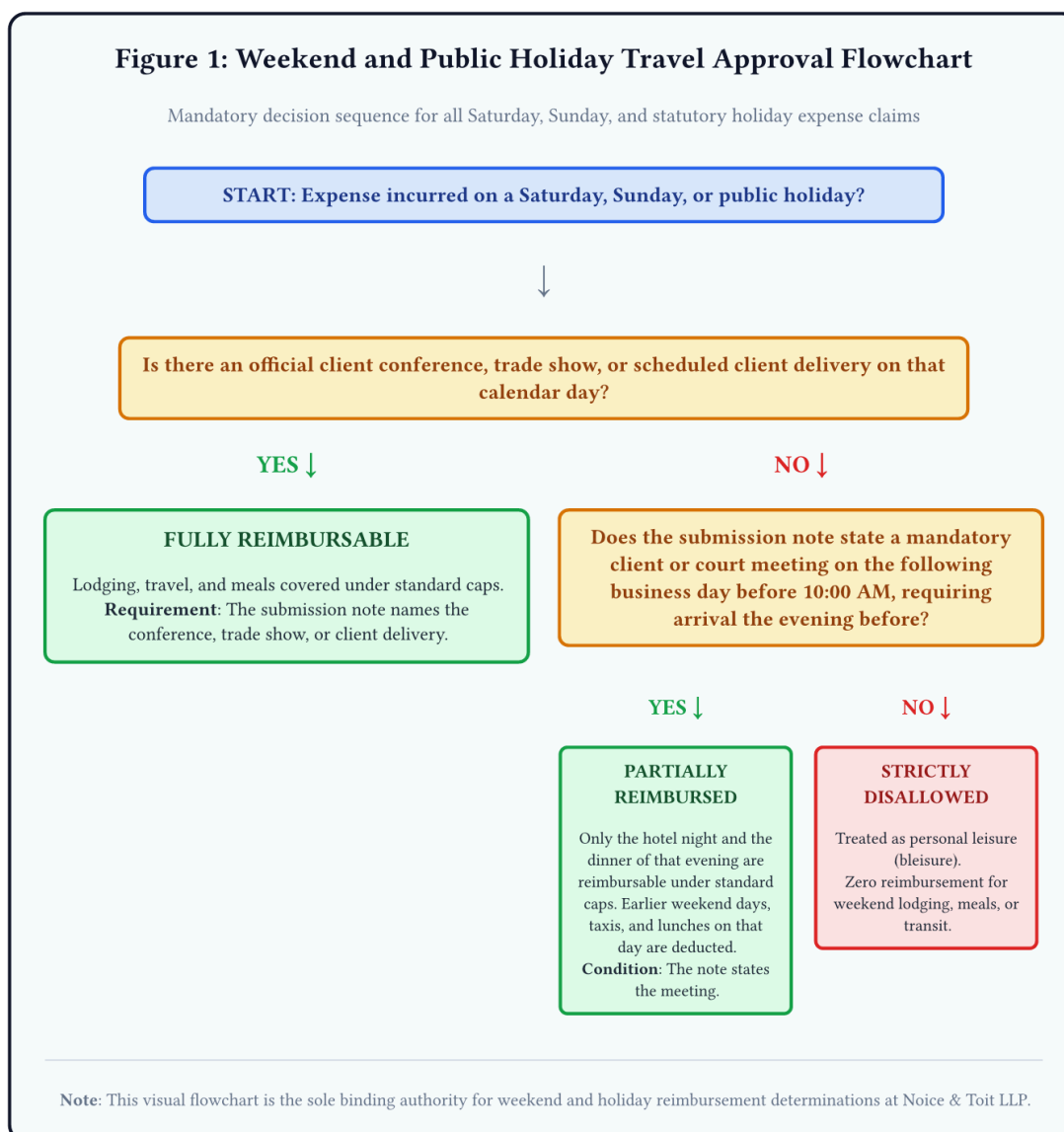


Figure 1: Figure 1: Weekend and Public Holiday Travel Approval Flowchart

13.3 Dining, Entertainment, and Beverage Approval Matrix

All meals, whether solo, internal, or hosted, are evaluated against the multi-factor criteria in Figure 2. The dining category is determined from the attendee composition stated in the note (Chapter 8).

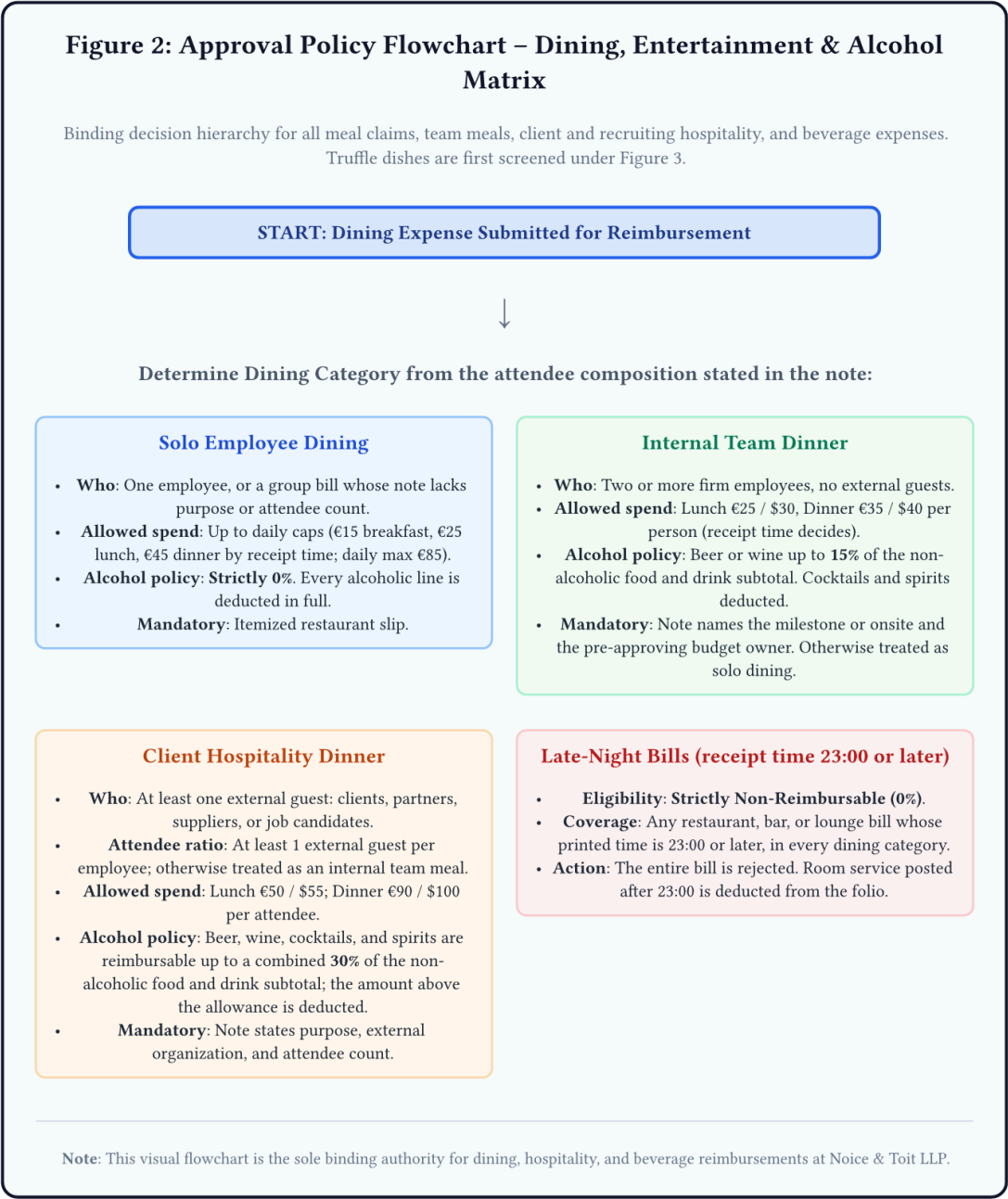


Figure 2: Figure 2: Approval Policy Flowchart – Dining, Entertainment & Alcohol Matrix

13.4 Truffle Policy Flowchart

Every restaurant line item whose description mentions truffle is screened under Figure 3 before the dining caps in Figure 2 are applied. A dish that reaches a red branch is deducted at its gross line price.

Figure 3: Truffle Policy Flowchart – Luxury Ingredient Screening

Applied to every restaurant line item mentioning truffle, before the dining caps of Figure 2

START: Line item description mentions truffle (Trüffel, tartufo, truffe, truffle oil, truffle butter, shaved truffle ...)



Step 1: Is the line a pure truffle supplement or upcharge? (“add shaved truffle”, “truffle supplement”, “extra truffle”)

YES ↓

NO ↓

DEDUCT THE SUPPLEMENT

The upcharge line is deducted in full. The dish it was added to is screened separately from Step 2.

Continue to Step 2.

Step 2: Is the dish a main course? A side, starter, shared plate, garnish, sauce, fries, dessert, or bar snack is not a main.

NO ↓

YES ↓

REIMBURSABLE

Sides, starters, and desserts with truffle are ordinary food. Normal dining caps of Figure 2 apply.

Continue to Step 3.

Step 3: Is the unit price of the main strictly below €40.00 / \$45.00 / £35.00 per portion?

YES ↓

NO ↓

REIMBURSABLE

A modest truffle main is fine. Normal dining caps of Figure 2 apply.

DEDUCT THE DISH

The entire line (quantity × unit price) is deducted, plus any tax charged on top of it. The rest of the bill continues to Figure 2.

Note: This flowchart is the sole binding authority for truffle dishes at Noice & Toit LLP. It applies to solo meals, internal team meals, and client hospitality alike. Minibar truffle snacks are minibar items and are deducted under Chapter 6 regardless of this figure.

Figure 3: Figure 3: Truffle Policy Flowchart – Luxury Ingredient Screening

13.5 Navigating Edge Cases and Escalation Procedures

When a proposed client engagement or emergency travel scenario presents an unprecedented set of facts that does not clearly fit into the branches of Figures 1 to 3:

- The employee must prepare a short written briefing note outlining the client context, financial scale, and operational urgency.
- The briefing note must be submitted to the Practice Group Leader and the Head of Global Finance for joint determination.
- Verbal determinations or informal email notes from colleagues will not be accepted during retrospective compliance audits.

14 Appendix: Reference Tables and Global Schedules

14.1 Global Hotel Nightly Room Rate Caps

The following caps apply to the nightly room rate as printed on the folio, exclusive of municipal tourism taxes and VAT added on top. The hotel's city determines the tier:

Tier	Metropolitan Markets Covered	EUR (€)	USD (\$)	GBP (£)
Tier 1	London, New York City, San Francisco, Zurich, Geneva, Paris, Tokyo, Singapore, Hong Kong	€220.00	\$250.00	£190.00
Tier 2	Berlin, Munich, Frankfurt, Hamburg, Amsterdam, Dublin, Chicago, Boston, Seattle, Toronto, Sydney, Milan	€160.00	\$180.00	£140.00
Tier 3	All other cities, secondary metropolitan markets, university hubs, and suburban districts	€120.00	\$140.00	£105.00

During declared trade-fair and congress weeks, the event surcharge caps in Chapter 9 override these tier caps for the host city when the submission note names the listed event.

14.2 Hotel Incidental Allowances

Folio Line	EUR (€)	USD (\$)	GBP (£)	Condition
Laundry, stay over 5 nights	€35.00 / 7 days	\$40.00 / 7 days	£30.00 / 7 days	None
Garment rescue, stay of 5 nights or fewer	€25.00 / stay	\$30.00 / stay	£22.00 / stay	Note describes the soiling incident
Parking incl. valet and EV charging	€30.00 / night	\$35.00 / night	£26.00 / night	Note identifies rental or pool vehicle
City tax, tourism levy	Full	Full	Full	Itemized on folio
Minibar, spa, movies, pet fee, gym	€0.00	\$0.00	£0.00	Always deducted

14.3 Daily Meal Allowances and Spending Limits (Solo Dining)

Meal limits are based on actual, itemized receipts up to the stated maximum caps. The receipt time selects the category:

Meal Category	EUR (€)	USD (\$)	GBP (£)	Receipt Time
Breakfast	€15.00	\$18.00	£13.00	Before 11:00
Lunch	€25.00	\$30.00	£22.00	11:00 to 15:59
Dinner	€45.00	\$55.00	£38.00	16:00 onward
Overtime meal at home office	€20.00	\$25.00	£18.00	After 20:30, note states late work
Daily Aggregate Cap	€85.00	\$100.00	£73.00	Maximum cumulative reimbursement per calendar day

Group dining caps (internal team meals and client hospitality) are set exclusively in Figure 2, Chapter 13.

14.4 Personal Vehicle Mileage Rates

Country / Jurisdiction	Statutory Rate	Required Documentation
European Union (Standard)	€0.38 / km	Departure and arrival addresses, verified map distance
United States (IRS Benchmark)	\$0.67 / mile	Itemized mileage log with client project citation
United Kingdom (HMRC Tier 1)	£0.45 / mile	First 10,000 business miles in tax year
United Kingdom (HMRC Tier 2)	£0.25 / mile	Excess business miles above 10,000 miles
Bicycle Allowance (All regions)	€0.25 / km	Business visits under 20km round-trip
Rental or pool vehicle fuel	Actual receipt	Fuel line only; shop items deducted; note names the rental

14.5 Global Tipping and Gratuity Standards

The cap is calculated on the bill before tip. It applies to restaurants and taxis alike. The vendor's country governs. Where a country-specific row below differs from the regional norms in Chapter 7, the row below governs.

Country / Region	Maximum Tip	Policy Guidance
United States & Canada	20%	Table service and taxis. Counter service, takeout, and delivery: \$1.00 maximum
United Kingdom	12.5%	Only if no service charge is printed on the bill; printed service charge is reimbursed, extra tip deducted
Germany	20%	Generous rounding for good service is customary and fully supported; takeaway and delivery: no tip reimbursed
EU countries (France, Spain, Italy, Netherlands, ...)	10%	Service included by law; takeaway and delivery: no tip reimbursed
Switzerland	10%	Service included; rounding up is customary
Japan, South Korea	0%	Tipping is not customary; any tip deducted
Singapore, Hong Kong	0%	Printed 10% service charge reimbursed; any additional tip deducted

14.6 Pre-Submission Compliance Checklist

Before clicking submit in the Noice & Toit Expense Portal, verify the following items:

- ☐ Every receipt is itemized. No summary credit card terminal slips are used as sole proof of spend.
- ☐ Hotel folios and commercial invoices show the vendor's VAT registration number.
- ☐ The note states the facts this handbook requires for the receipt type (Chapter 2).
- ☐ Solo meals contain zero alcoholic beverages, or you have deducted them yourself.

- [] Group meals state the business purpose, the external organization, and the attendee count.
- [] Tips are within the local cap in the table above.
- [] Any truffle dish passes Figure 3 (Chapter 13).
- [] Weekend or public holiday receipts and hotel nights comply with Figure 1 (Chapter 13).
- [] Group dining complies with Figure 2 (Chapter 13).
- [] Minibar, spa, movie, and pet charges have been deducted from hotel folios.
- [] Fuel receipts name the rental vehicle; shop items are deducted.
- [] Event materials name the event and the pre-approving budget owner.
- [] The claim is submitted within thirty (30) calendar days of transaction completion.

14.7 Global Finance Directory and Contact Information

For inquiries regarding travel bookings, card management, or expense auditing:

- **Global Travel Desk:** travel@noiceandtoit.internal (24/7 emergency flight changes and duty of care support).
- **Expense Auditing Team:** expenses@noiceandtoit.internal (receipt verification and policy clarifications).
- **Corporate Card Administration:** corporatecards@noiceandtoit.internal (card issuance, limits, and lost cards).
- **Accounts Payable / Disbursements:** finance-disbursements@noiceandtoit.internal (payroll payout schedules).
- **Truffle Hotline:** truffles@noiceandtoit.internal (yes, really; see Chapter 13).